

WHY HUMAN-DERIVED EXTINCTION IS NATURAL AND HOW TO VIEW EXTINCTION PROCESS

Since the beginning of life, there always has been a process for new species to emerge and a process for old species to go extinct. These processes wipe out up to 95 percent of all species in one fell swoop, doing this periodically (Pyrton, 2017). There are those who think mankind should put effort to protect currently extincting endangered species and there are those who see the extinction as a natural occurrence and it is not to be intervened. Despite the debates, it is evident that logical and rational course of action for mankind to pursue is to behave as natural as possible. By behaving natural, it is meant that to live by the laws of nature. The fact that lies behind the actions of humans that are mostly considered unnatural and artificial, and the reason for impossibility to maintain status quo stands as logical grounds for this course of natural extinction.

Firstly, when considering reasons, methods and consequences of human actions, it must be taken into account that humans are as part of nature just as any animal, plant or even microorganism. And they live by the same purposes: to survive and to reproduce. To achieve these purposes, mankind interacts with the environment which it is in, in these actions environment

is harvested by humans for food, water supplies, energy sources etc. By doing all these nature is shaped by humans, resulting in reduction or even extinction of some species. Though this might seem unnatural at first glance, it is the same occurrence as beavers building a dam, causing some species to go extinct and some to thrive (Pyrone, 2017). It can therefore be argued that actions of mankind are as natural as any other natural occurrence, considering humans as a part of nature, and it is, in fact, unnatural to intervene nature's process of extinction.

As for the debate about preservation of status quo, to achieve full understanding of the topic, environment and mass extinctions must be observed. As Pyrone (2017) denotes, "Mass extinctions periodically wipe out up to 95 percent of all species in one fell swoop. These come every 50 million to 100 million years, and scientists agree that we are now in the middle of the sixth such extinction" (p. 1). The fact that mankind (which is conscious) for its environment and other species happens to be in an extinction phase of nature enables mankind to witness 'extinctions' in high rates. The changes in nature of this scale happen as a result of changes in geology and astronomy (Pyrone, 2017).

Since the reasons for huge changes in nature, therefore in species, are too strong and non-intervenable it can be concluded that preserving nature and all of its species as they are is beyond the limit what is possible for humans, making putting effort in preservation unnecessary.

Some critics argue that extinction of even a single species has potential to cause a disaster for all species. As Cho (2019) claims, "While it may seem unimportant if we lose one salamander or rat species, it matters because all species are connected through their interactions in a web of life. Healthy ecosystems are more productive and resistant to disruptions (p. 1)." It is made clear that the importance of interconnections in an ecosystem, underlying every single species' duty, it is understandable why this stance might appear logical. However, this approach fails to consider result of any disruption on big scale. For example world is neither better nor worse for the extinction of saber-toothed tigers or Neanderthals (Pyro, 2017). The unpleasant appearance of the fact that many species gone extinct resulting from mankind's superior mind, since it has a sense of justice.

To conclude, the question about whether to see extinction as a problem to be solved or see extinction as a natural occurrence has a definite answer of viewing reasons and process of extinction as a trait of nature. Considering humans as a part of nature, leading to the natural trait of consequences of its actions, and seeing how unnatural it is to try to stop changes in nature, since to stop these changes would require intervention with un-interventionable phenomena like geology, prove that evaluating extinction as process of nature and not something to be disturbed.